The potential of opening a café in Stige (Denmark)

Gabor Wagner

Haaga-Helia University of Applied Sciences

Bachelor of Hospitality Management

Thesis

2025

Abstract

Author(s)
Gabor Wagner

Degree
Bachelor of Hospitality Management

Report/Thesis Title
Market research: The potential of opening a cafe in Stige, Denmark

Number of pages and appendix pages
30+1

The purpose of this thesis was to examine the potential of opening a café in Stige, a small town in Denmark, and to explore how such an establishment could contribute to both local community life and sustainable small-town development. The study investigated the needs, preferences, and expectations of local residents regarding café services and atmosphere, and assessed whether a café could strengthen social belonging and local identity in Stige.

The theoretical framework of the study focuses on literature about café culture, community engagement, and the sociological concept of "third places. The research also integrated the Danish cultural concept of hygge- a feeling of coziness, comfort, and togetherness- which is central to the social experience of cafés in Denmark. Additionally, the study considered current trends in café culture, such as the growing emphasis on quality, authenticity, and the integration of local and sustainable practices in hospitality services. These theoretical perspectives provided a foundation for understanding how a café could function not only as a business but also as a social and cultural hub.

The empirical research was conducted through an online survey distributed among Stige residents via social media. The total of 196 responses was analyzed to determine what products, services, and experiences potential customers value most. The results indicated a strong interest in a café that combines good-quality coffee, healthy and homemade food, and a friendly and personal atmosphere. Respondents valued authenticity, affordability, and social events, such as live music, community gatherings, over long opening hours or high-end products. Many residents expressed a wish for a café that would provide a relaxed and inclusive environment suitable for families, individuals, and different age groups.

The findings confirm that opening a café in Stige could be both a feasible business and a valuable social initiative.

Key words
Café culture, small-town development, community engagement, local identity, hygge, Denmark

Table of Contents

1 Introduction 1
1.1 Objectives and Methods 1
1.2 Demarcations 2
1.3 Key concepts in short 3
2 Coffee culture in Denmark and main services 4
2.1 Brief history of coffee 4
2.2 Different types of cafes 5
2.3 New trends in café culture 8
2.4 Products and services in a cafés 9
2.5 Hygge as a global trend (a tradition can attract global attention) 10
3 Surveying potential customers 13
3.1 Results of the location of responders 14
3.2 Results of hosting community events, personal service, and opening hours of the cafe 14
3.3 Results of the product quality, alcoholic beverages, and healthy food 17
3.4 Results of local culture, and the café as a meeting place 21
3.5 Results of what would enhance the visit to the café 23
4 Discussion 25
4.1 Research process and evaluation 25
4.2 Conclusions and future outlook 26
References 29
Appendices 31
Appendix 1. The survey questions 31

1 Introduction

The primary purpose of this study is to investigate the opening of a cafe in Stige, a small town of 3000 inhabitants in Fyn, Denmark. The establishment of a cafe in Stige, Denmark, presents a possible opportunity for both community engagement and a chance for locals to enjoy a hospitality service on the local level. This paper will search for the viability of this undertaking through an analysis of relevant demand, economic, and social factors that define the local environment. By assessing community preferences and current market dynamics, this research aims to provide comprehensive insights into the potential success of a cafe in this small town. The study will investigate the factors that influence the need for a cafe, focusing on aspects such as the types of services that are important, the types of products that are valued, and whether the cafe would increase social belonging. Understanding these parameters is the most important, as they help to discern the local consumers' capacity and willingness to support a new cafe.

I have lived in Stige with my family for six years now, and it is my impression that the town has the potential for a place that would serve both the local community and eventual passers-by or visitors. Regarding culinary and cultural choices, Stige offers a limited portfolio. Apart from the church concert 2-3 times a year, a flea market in the summer, a Saint Hans bonfire in June, and a community gym will be formed in the near future, there is nothing more. Local citizens do not have many possibilities to meet or gather unless it is their children's athletic training, school-related activity, or church service. The village lacks a place that can serve as a community hub, where the daily life of a local person would meet culinary choices with some cultural aspects. After some communications with my fellow local people, I feel there is a right to the existence of a place that I investigate. I believe such a place would make a difference in the life of Stige. One of the words that often comes up with Denmark is hygge. The word cannot be directly translated, but the meaning would be togetherness or coziness. Part of this environment or feeling is often a shared coffee experience with others. It is undeniable that coffee is deeply ingrained in Danish culture, in both social and personal aspects. (Fyns Amts Avis 2023). Understanding and integrating this cultural phenomenon into the new establishment would be important.

1.1 Objectives and Methods

The problem statement in this research is that Stige, a small town of approximately 4,000 inhabitants in Fyn, Denmark, lacks a dedicated café or communal gathering space. Apart from occasional church concerts, a summer flea market, and the annual Saint Hans bonfire, there are few opportunities for residents to meet outside of school, sports, or religious activities. This absence of a social venue may limit community engagement and restrict local options for leisure and hospitality services. The primary objective of this study is to answer the question: Is there a need for a café in Stige? I will

assess the feasibility of opening a café in Stige by analyzing local demand, social impact, and service demand. With my study, I plan to achieve multiple goals. Firstly, I want to identify the needs and specific preferences of the local community. By understanding the local residents, I want to find the answers to the existing interest in a café. My focus will be on the customer demand, specifically the expectations regarding services and products. On the other hand, I want to explore whether a café could serve as a community hub, promote social interactions, and improve the town´s cultural life. By addressing these objectives, this research will provide insights into whether a cafe in Stige is a successful and sustainable business idea. My personal background of working for twelve years in the hospitality industry has strongly influenced my understanding of café culture and customer expectations. Through this experience, I have learned how service quality, atmosphere, and attention to detail directly affect customer satisfaction and business success.

The method of the thesis is a survey. To achieve the research objectives, the survey will be conducted on Stiges' most popular social media platform for primary data collection. The questionnaire will be sent through the Internet, and the results will be used as quantitative data. In the theoretical framework, I will use other sources and references. To gain knowledge of the local cultural possibilities and the environment of Danish cafes, I will conduct a so-called" expertise interview", where a café co-owner operating in very similar circumstances will share some valuable information. The answers of the interview will be used only as references in the theoretical framework. Artificial intelligence will be used as a brainstorming tool, and some parts for the formation of the survey.

To determine the feasibility and potential impact of opening a café in Stige, this study will address the following key research question: **Is there a need for a café in Stige?**

To explore this broad question in more detail, sub-questions will be used, regarding the types of services and products that would be most valued, as well as the possible impact on social habits.

- What services are important?
- What kind of products are valued?
- Would the café increase the social belonging in Stige?

1.2 Demarcations

This study focuses specifically on Stige and the nearby surroundings. Some comparisons may be used from other small towns in Denmark, but the findings will be sized to the conditions of Stige. The study will not focus on the physical location or a specific site location within Stige.

1.3 Key concepts in short

Café Culture: Café culture refers to the social and cultural role of cafes as places where people meet, relax, and engage in daily life. In Denmark, cafés are not only places to buy food and beverages but also serve as informal gathering spaces that encourage conversation and connection.

Hygge: Hygge is a fundamental Danish concept that represents coziness, warmth, and a sense of togetherness. It is often associated with enjoying simple pleasures like drinking coffee in a relaxed atmosphere. Since the study explores whether a café could contribute to social belonging, the integration of hygge is key to understanding how a café might enhance community life in Stige.

Community Engagement: This concept refers to the ways in which local residents participate in and contribute to their social environment. A café has the potential to strengthen community engagement by providing a shared space where people can interact beyond structured activities such as school or sports events. Assessing whether Stige residents desire and would support such a space is essential to the study.

Social Belonging: Social belonging is the sense of being part of a group or community. In small towns like Stige, public spaces where people can meet informally are limited, which may impact social cohesion. By evaluating whether a café would foster stronger social connections, this study examines its potential role as a community hub.

Consumer Preferences: Consumer preferences include the tastes, expectations, and behaviors of potential café customers. Understanding what products and services residents value helps determine whether a café could attract loyal customers. This concept directly relates to the study's goal of identifying which offerings would be most appealing to the Stige community.

2 Coffee culture in Denmark and main services

In the second chapter, I will present a short history of coffee and the diversity of cafés. It will be followed by some text about café culture and some cultural phenomena of Denmark. The theoretical framework of this study provides the basis for understanding the key aspects that influence the feasibility of opening a café in Stige. By examining relevant literature and industry trends, this section focuses on three main topics: the diversity of cafés in Denmark, new trends in coffee culture, and the role of services and products in cafés. Denmark has a well-established café culture, ranging from traditional coffeehouses to modern specialty cafés. Understanding its coffee culture and the wide selection of cafés helps identify which models are most successful and how they cater to different consumer segments. Additionally, new trends in coffee culture, such as specialty brews and third-wave coffee movements, are reshaping consumer expectations and influencing how cafés operate. Exploring the services and product offerings becomes very important, as the success of a café often depends on the right combination of atmosphere, menu selection, and customer experience.

2.1 Brief history of coffee

It would not be appropriate to study coffee and café culture without its history. Coffee originates in Africa, and its earliest uses are documented in Ethiopia and Yemen. Consumption of coffee was also among the Arabs of the Middle East during the early Middle Ages. It probably reached Europe via the Ottomans in the sixteenth century. The colonization process of Asia by England and Holland in the seventeenth century created new routes for the beans to reach the continent. In the nineteenth century, with the invention of the steamboat, imports from South America were also made possible, and Brazil eventually became the dominant coffee exporter in the world. By the nineteenth century, all major European cities (Venice, Berlin, Vienna, Paris, and London) had opened their coffee houses. (Kleldgaard and Ostberg 2007, p. 177). The beginning of the twentieth century saw the discovery of instant coffee and the Italian mass production of espresso machines. The coffee reached unprecedented popularity in our century, especially with the rise of popular coffee chains like Starbucks (for a detailed timeline, see Tucker, 143-146). But by now, coffee is also present in most people’s homes and workplaces.

Scandinavia was in line with the international developments from the start. In 1687, it was placed on the approved drugs list of the pharmacies in Sweden. By now, Scandinavia has the world’s highest per capita coffee consumption and a diverse café scene. (Kjeldgaard and Ostberg, Coffee Grounds, 2007, pp. 177-178).

2.2 Different types of cafes

It is impossible to exaggerate the role coffee consumption plays in the lives of people around the world. It accompanies people on many occasions on their journey through life. Often compared to petroleum for cars, it is the fuel humans run on, and in fact, these two substances are leading the consumption statistics worldwide (Tucker 2011, 11). People drink this beverage at home, at work, and it also accompanies them in their social gatherings. This thesis, however, is not concerned with consumption at home and work, but in coffee shops. Anthropologists, historians, and economists alike attempted to account for coffee's attractiveness, and they all agree that it is more than just its energizing effect that caused its popularity. A coffee shop or a café, according to sociologist Ray Oldenburg, is a so-called “third space.” According to Oldenburg, third spaces are neutral public places where people can gather and interact, and thus are of utmost importance for people’s social interactions and societal changes. Without such places, people are restricted to a home-work commute, which is disruptive for communal life, and interactions within the community become minimal. (Oldenburg 2002, 1-7). Coffeeshop types in Scandinavia are mostly variations of some global types. According to Kjeldgaard and Ostberg, who analyzed cafés in Sweden and in Denmark in 2007, there are 3 main models: the Americana, the culinarian, and the Viennese.

The Americana is represented by the franchises of Starbucks and similar companies (Espresso House, Baresso, McDonald’s McCafe), which are characterized by their uniformity; they recognizably use the same décor, music, coffee types, etc. (Kjeldgaard and Ostberg, 2007, 181-182)

The culinaria is modelled on Italian cafés and French brasseries. These cafés are keen to emanate an atmosphere of ‘authenticity’ both in terms of serving coffee, but also in food (croissants, cornettos, gourmet sandwiches, etc.). It caters to people who like to see themselves as connoisseurs. (Kjeldgaard and Ostberg, 2007, 182-183)

The Viennese are the most traditional types, as they are historically the oldest, and at their foundations, they were modelled on the nineteenth-century Viennese café scene. Their staple offer is the (Danish) pastry served in traditional and elegant settings (Kjeldgaard and Ostberg, 2007, 183-184). Kjeldgaard and Ostberg note that one finds on the Scandinavian scene mixtures of the three types as well.

In smaller towns, however, cafés frequently combine several of these social and commercial roles. While urban cafés can specialize, a rural café must meet multiple needs at once: offering coffee, food, and cultural activities in the same venue. This multifunctional approach is also emphasized by café owner Kristoffer Korshøj, who co-owned a small-town café in Denmark. (Korshøj 2025). He explains that his motivation for opening the café was “to create a much-needed meeting place and

a cultural hub for the small community, a venue for music, art, and great discussions." His experience highlights the various roles such cafés play: they are both commercial enterprises and social infrastructures responding to a lack of informal gathering spaces. Korshøj's observations are similar to Oldenburg's (2002) concept of the café as a "third place." In contrast to city cafés that compete through branding or specialization, small-town cafés compete by fostering a feeling of community and being integrated into the local way of life.

Another analytical framework that can be applied in a discussion about various café types is the one developed by Terry Nichols Clark. He distinguishes across several parameters what social roles a café might have. His schemes are complex, but here are some of the important parameters: it will depend on whether it caters to families, solitary workers, convivial friends, the observer, the news-consumer, or all of them, and whether it is aimed at local residents, workers, and whether it has entertainment and/or political purposes. (Clark 2013 221-229).

Most of these typologies are developed when studying large urban scenes, where the number and diversity of consumers allow for a diversity of café types. In my opinion, a small-town café needs to be constructed at the meeting point of several of these parameters, being the unique establishment in that place: it will be used by families and commuters; it needs to function as a pastry shop with sandwiches and perhaps light lunch, coffee for those who are just in for an average quality warm refreshment and those who can appreciate a good espresso. It has to make room for entertainment for different demographics and also has to function as a meeting place for local initiatives, whether it is for leisure or cultural.

Without being exhaustive, here is a brief list of various cafes in Odense. Why Odense? Because with its 210,000 inhabitants, Odense is Denmark's third-largest city. (Odense Kommune 2025). The focus of this list is rather on the additional services than the actual selection and quality of the coffee.

Café Sølle is a little café in the city center. It is owned by two brothers who have been operating a little café wagon for years in the city parks, learning the trade and adjusting to the demands. It is a nicely decorated place offering a variety of hot drinks, cold drinks, cold food, and snacks. Their hot drink selection features eight kinds of coffee, cocoa, and a variety of selected teas. Café Sølle often has selected local alcoholic beverages and bakes its own bread buns and cakes. There is a little shop here where the selected wines and beers, and goods can be bought too. It operates between Wednesday and Saturday from 10 am until different times, typically later in the end of the week. There is a rather rare policy that at certain times, computer and mobile phone usage is suggested to a minimum. (Café Sølle 2025)

Café Paraplyen, a social cafe, has a church background and provides a humanitarian effort to the people in need. It operates in the very center of Odense. The operation is based on grants, foundations, and its own profit. There are social workers and volunteers who are always there to listen and help. It is an alcohol free place, with its own self-help group around alcohol problems. The social café offers a cheap daily menu with a hot drink for an affordable price of EUR 6.7 (1 EUR=7.5 DKK), coffee for EUR 0.7, and a sandwich for EUR 1,4. On the September 2025 program, we can find free activities such as acupuncture, knitting, group walking, swimming, board games, and more, including a course to help you stop smoking. Café Paraplyen has been operating since 1989. The focus is rather on the service for the community, and it has been working this way for the last 36 years. (Café Paraplyen 2025)

Café Unika is a modern café bar in the city center of Odense. In fact, there are two of them. Two years after the success of the first one in 2021, the second one opened. The company is owned by three sisters who were traveling the world, living in various countries, and gathering ideas and concepts. It seems all that worked well. The pastel color world works well with the modern menu, offering bowls, all-day menus, toasts, salads, and more. The healthy lineup includes the latest food trends and uses avocado, apple-smoked ham, sourdough bread, and Duroc ham. On the drink front, the healthy approach is continued with a wide selection of freshly squeezed juices, coffees, teas, alcoholic beverages of selected vines and bubbles. Coffee beans are imported from a Guatemalan organic coffee farm. The unique part of Café Unika is their in-boutique shop, where one can find handmade pottery, clothes, and hats. (Café Unika 2025)

Yonobi is not a coffee drinking place per se, but rather a creative concept. Opened in May 2024 in Odense, as the newest member of the three in Denmark. Yonobi is offering a pottery-making space with individual tables for a minimum of two hours, with firing and glazing included in the price. There are also events and workshops on their cultural palette, such as kombucha and matcha workshops, clay-circle member hangouts, and a ceramic flag-making event. The actual coffee corner is called Pinch Pot Café. The selection includes hot beverages, cakes, and juices. Pre-booking of the pottery tables is necessary, especially on holidays and weekends. (Pinch Pot Café in Odense 2025)

Papas Papbar is the centre of board game lovers. With their selection of more than 600 board games, they are certainly not playing around. The guests can pre-book any board games, and should problems appear, there is always a “Game Guru” who can help with the rules. There are gaming events and even a podcast. On the drink menu, there are hot and cold drinks, craft beer, and cocktails. One can buy selected paninis and snacks to eat. The location of the café could not

be better. In arm's length of the main tourist attractions, not only the locals, but also the city visitors can enjoy its service. (Papas Papbar 2025)

Café StudieStuen provides a quiet and warm environment for students. Located in the centre of the city, the students can study, do their homework, or have a study group meeting. Used study books can be bought and sold. Cultural and poetry events often happen. The café relies on volunteers who contribute to the daily tasks. The setup seems solid, because the students have found their peace there since 2010. They are selling hot and cold drinks, including selected coffees and little snacks. (Café StudieStuen 2025)

Studenterhus Odense offers a great selection of cultural events for the more outgoing students. There are programs for nearly every day, from concerts to film festivals and other events. There are spaces of various sizes, and they can be booked for any occasion, from yoga to talking about beer. The Studenterhus has a large café with hot and cold drinks, a proper bar of alcoholic beverages and snacks and sandwiches to eat. Students can use their Student card for a discount. Volunteering is also popular here. Students can use Studenterhus as a work practice place. (Studenterhus 2025)

Tal Dansk Kafe helps migrants with their Danish skills. Open only on Monday afternoons, their aim is to create a warm atmosphere and talk in Danish with foreigners. The menu is limited to coffee, tea, and sandwiches. Every three months, they organize an international dinner night. (Odenseim 2025)

2.3 New trends in café culture

Coffee and Danish culture have a long history together, dating back to the 17th century. Older generations are still drinking the so-called "Swedish coffee," where one pours hot water over the coffee grind. The most popular method is filter coffee (almindelig kaffee or ordinary coffee), using conventional coffee. Changes to the traditions emerged in the 21st century, when a few individuals, including Klaus Thomsen, one of the founders of Coffee Collective, recognized the market opportunity to introduce high-quality coffee. (Coffee Collective 2025). Coffee Collectives' other fundamental pillar is transparency. On the company's website, one can see the partner farmers. A special bonus is given to the farmers for their dedication to extra quality. From having a few coffee shops that sold quality coffee, Denmark developed into a well-known destination for specialty coffee. Holy Bean Coffee Roasters are from a tiny village in Fyn. (Holy Bean Coffee Roasters 2025). They are specialised in light roast. They provide wholesale service and coffee courses for businesses. Another popular name is La Cabra from Aarhus (La Cabra 2025). La Cabra has two cafes in Aarhus and one in Copenhagen. They also have a bakery and a roasting house. On their webshop, there is a

wide selection of coffee beans and tea, clothing, presents, and all the additional devices needed for modern coffee and tea making. La Cabra entered the international market and operates a shop in the USA, Oman, and Bangkok in Thailand.

Danish coffee culture has become more diverse, moving from classic filter coffee toward espresso machines, French presses, and capsules. There is a growing focus on whole beans and freshly brewed coffee rather than instant, showing a shift toward quality, taste, and brewing methods associated with specialty coffee. Consumers are more curious and selective, spending more time choosing beans and methods to achieve their favorite cup. Most importantly, coffee remains a deeply social practice: from morning routines to workplace breaks and cozy café visits (Coffee and Tea Industry Association 2024).

2.4 Products and services in a cafés

If we investigate the products of some of the cafes in Odense, I mentioned previously, there are no significant differences from the global trends. It is a mix of customary drinks and a selection of more sophisticated and healthier options. For instance, **Café Unika**`s menu includes warm drinks, cold drinks, juices, shakes, and a daily boost (Café Unika 2025). The coffee line-up includes Americano, Espresso, Cortado, Flat White, Cappuccino, and Kaffee Latte. It is followed by the Latte line up, including Chai Latte, Matcha Latte, Golden Latte (curcuma and ginger), and Rødbede Latte (cold-pressed beetroot juice with vanilla soy milk). The tea selection includes Earl Grey, Cool Mint, and White Hawthorn tea. The cold drink section includes Icecoffee, Frappe, Icematcha, Icechai, a selection of local fruit juices, Colas, water, and beer. There are eight different juice options made of healthy fruits and greens, including passion fruit or spirulina. There is a mixed fruit shake and a daily boost with ginger. On the food side of their menu, there is also a great selection one can find. It starts with three kinds of Combos, called Simple Breakfast, Unika Combo, and Half-Half. The common thing in them is the healthy approach, using organic sourdough, homemade raspberry jam, granola, chia porridge, coconut flakes, and hemp seeds. All-day menus are also served, using some healthy options again, including rye bread, Greek yogurt porridge, avocado toast, and some sweet plates like waffles, banana bread, lemon pie, and cookies. The menu continues with four healthy bowls using selected fruits, salads, and seeds, like mango, papaya, dates, spinach, chia seeds, hemp seeds, and coconut flakes. There are toasts, salads, and rye bread options, all of which reflect the modern and healthy lifestyle. Café Unika offers some extras on the service side, too. Their webshop has a great selection of handmade pottery, woven articles, clothes, and presents. Let's take another example from Odense. **Café Sølle** is a small, young-generation-owned café in the city centre. (Café Sølle 2025). The warm drinks selection includes: Espresso, Americano, Filter Coffee, Cortado, Flat White, Cappuccino, Latte, Ice Coffee, Chai Latte, Cacao with

cream, and selected tea. The cold drinks selection includes fresh juices, fizzy sodas, and sparkling wine. The food menu includes toast, sourdough sandwiches, home-baked goods, and sweet options. There are snacks, including olive mix, chips, and peanuts. Café Sølle sells a great selection of beer, cider, and wine. As an extra service, they opened a little shop next door and sell alcoholic beverages and selected coffee from all around the world. The common thing I find in both products is the large selection and the emphasis on homemade and healthy choices. If we investigate the services of the cafes in Odense, there are multiple variations. **Café Paraplyen** emphasizes social aspects, helps people in need, and is a safe point more than a leisure café. **Yonobi** offers an environment where guests can experience the making of pottery. Pappas Bar is the home of board games and attracts groups who are interested not in playing the games at home but in a city environment. There are two different ways the city cafes offer to students. **Café Studiestuen** provides a quiet atmosphere where the students find the right space for studying. On the other side, **Studenterhuset** is a vibrant place full of music, culture, and young energy. **Tal Dansk Kafe** is helping people from outside Denmark to learn the Danish language. As we can see, the additional services of the Odense cafes are varied, and they focus on different groups of society to attract guests. In smaller communities, however, different economic realities influence the café's offerings. According to Korshøj (2025), "it is hard to set the price level as high as in the city," emphasizing that affordability and familiarity are essential to keep local customers. He also noted that the most popular items in his café were "the coffee and other beverages, especially during concerts and events," suggesting that drinks and social experiences reinforce each other.

These insights align with findings from the Stige survey, where respondents valued friendly service and community events more than long opening hours or premium-grade coffee. They also support the idea that cafés in smaller towns should emphasize accessibility, local pricing, and a balance between simple quality products and meaningful experiences. Korshøj's comment about the importance of balancing "staff, customers, and opening hours" offers a practical reminder that sustainable management is essential when resources are limited. (Korshøj 2025). His experience shows that social vibrancy and financial sustainability must coexist for a rural café to succeed.

2.5 Hygge as a global trend (a tradition can attract global attention)

The word hygge comes from the Norwegian word meaning well-being. It is difficult to pronounce and difficult to translate. Interestingly, the world is known worldwide even though it comes from a small language. Hygge is rather a concept than a word. Why did it become so popular? There are many reasons for it, just like many meanings of the word. Some of the meanings associated with hygge are: a relaxed atmosphere, where time is spent together with people one loves, simple

enjoyment of cosy time, creating a warm atmosphere, and enjoying life (Visit Denmark 2025). People can be even by themselves and still call it hygge by experiencing the enjoyment of such. Even picking up my children from the school event was commented on by the teacher: “It was hyggelig!” Often, candlelight is part of the experience. Denmark is a Nordic country, and it has a long and dark winter. At its peak, the shortest daylight span lasts only 7 hours and 5 minutes on the 21st of December in Odense (Weather Spark 2025). Light is essential, and Danes are using it to the maximum. Light is the medium that brings the outside world into the homes. When it is dark, cold, and damp, even light can cheer up any lost soul. Wiking notes that the perfect hygge experience cannot be without a candle (Wiking 2016). Denmark is one of the happiest countries in the world. Holds the second place after Finland for the last eight years according to the World Happiness Data (World Happiness Data 2025). This factor could be one of the reasons explaining the global interest in hygge. The hygge concept moved well beyond its Scandinavian origins. Hygge resonates with well-being and balance in the fast and merciless digital world. On the other hand, the commercialization of hygge, like food culture, interior design, and branding, made it tangible and marketable. From a sociological perspective, the globalization of hygge demonstrates how a local tradition can grow when its core values meet the recent global cultural current.

Hygge, Cafes, and Social Well-being in Denmark

In Denmark, cafés are more than just places to buy things; they are also places where the cultural value of hygge is lived out in daily life. Hygge, which means a feeling of coziness, comfort, and easy togetherness, determines both the look and the social purpose of many Danish cafés. Soft lighting, candles, muted decorations, and loose seating arrangements are all done on purpose to create the warm, relaxed environment that Danes connect with feeling "at home" outside of their own homes (Wiking 2016, p. 32). Cafes, bars, parks, and community centers can serve as a third place that acts like a mediator between the home and work. Third places are essential for social interactions, offering accessibility, affordability, a welcoming, friendly atmosphere, and a playful mood. (Oldenburg 2002). They offer relaxed settings where friends may get together, coworkers can have casual conversations, or people can just sit among others without any expectations. The Danish emphasis on egalitarian contact, where social structures are loosened and everyone may connect on equal terms, is reflected in this accessibility. Korshøj’s reflections further highlight the true meaning of hygge in small-town cafés. He described his establishment as “a second living room for all and the people in the village” (Korshøj, 2025), repeating Wiking’s and Oldenburg’s ideas that cafés can serve as communal extensions of home life. (Wiking 2016; Oldenburg 2002). This idea of the café as a cozy, inclusive space where everyone feels welcome directly aligns with hygge’s social aspect — fostering togetherness, warmth, and informality. From this perspective, hygge is not merely a marketing theme, but also a means to shape social design. A successful

café in a town like Stige should incorporate these values through atmosphere, customer interaction, and community events. Korshøj's experience shows that when residents see the café as their shared space, loyalty and participation naturally grow, even if event sizes need to stay flexible to prevent fatigue ("the number of guests would drop over time," as he says). His story offers a practical understanding of how hygge, community, and sustainability come together in real-life café operations.

3 Surveying potential customers

This chapter outlines the survey used to collect primary data on the potential demand for a café in Stige, Denmark.

The survey was designed to address the three sub-questions of the thesis:

1. What services are important?
2. What kind of products are valued?
3. Would the café increase the social belonging in Stige?

The questionnaire was distributed digitally through Stige´s most popular closed social media group (Facebook 2025). It consisted of ten items grouped into three thematic blocks: services, products, and social impact. An extra item served as a demographic filter, asking respondents whether they live in Stige, nearby, or elsewhere. Previously, the questionnaire was sent, and a trial period was conducted, where people I know would test the platform. The questionnaire consisted of 11 questions (Appendix 1) and was administered between 19.09 and 28.09.2025 using Webropol online survey. The total number of respondents is 196. As background information, I have used the last question, which asked the respondents about their location. I am investigating Stige and the nearby villages for potential customers, and 99% of the answers came from that category. Only 1% of the 194 answers were from “somewhere else”. 10 items of the questionnaire (Q1-Q9, Q11) were closed-ended, using the Likert-type scale system. This survey tool helped me to measure the opinions of the respondents and to rate their level of agreement or disagreement by asking a series of statements (Johnson & Morgan 2016, 45). The open-ended question (Q10) enabled the respondents to express their opinions and ideas related to the three main areas of the research. In analyzing the survey results, the “average” values are reported. The average provides a single summary score that allows simple comparison between the items.

Survey structure

Services (Q1-Q3): Items on event hosting, friendliness of service, and opening hours, measured on a five-point importance scale (1=very unimportant, 5=significant).

Products (Q4-Q7): Items related to beverage quality, alcoholic offerings, healthy options, and vegetarian/vegan availability were also rated on a five-point importance scale.

Social impact (Q8-Q9): Items on cultural contribution and provision of a meeting place, rated on a five-point agreement scale (1=strongly disagree, 5=strongly agree).

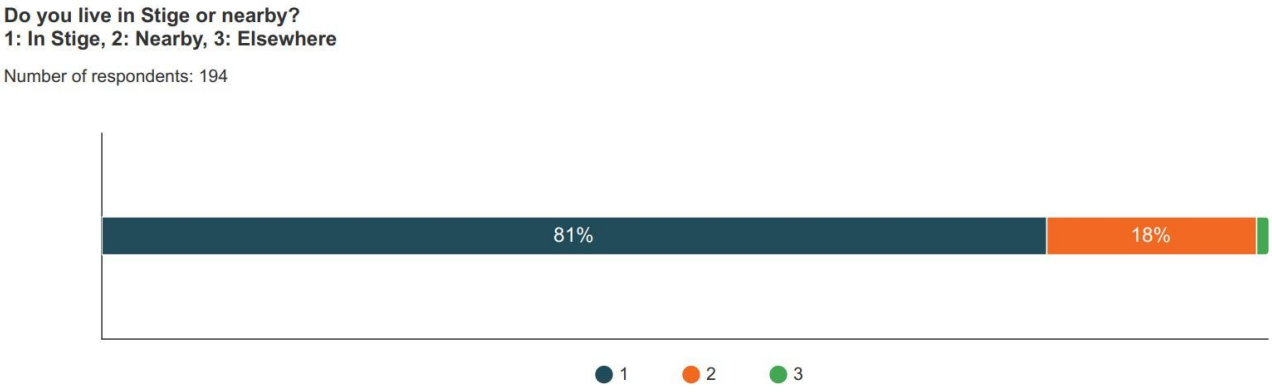
Open-ended question (Q10): “What services or products or cultural events would make you most likely to visit a café in Stige regularly?” This allowed respondents to provide qualitative insights beyond the fixed-choice categories.

Geographic insights (Q11): This data helps distinguish between core local demand and potential visitor interest.

3.1 Results of the location of responders

Do you live in Stige or nearby

Almost everybody, 99% of the respondents, are from Stige and the nearby. As I am investigating only these categories, the rest of the 1%, which means 2 people, is making such a minority that I feel I do not have to cross-examine the results between the location and other relevant answers.



	1	2	3	Average	Median
	81.5%	17.5%	1.0%	1.2	1.0

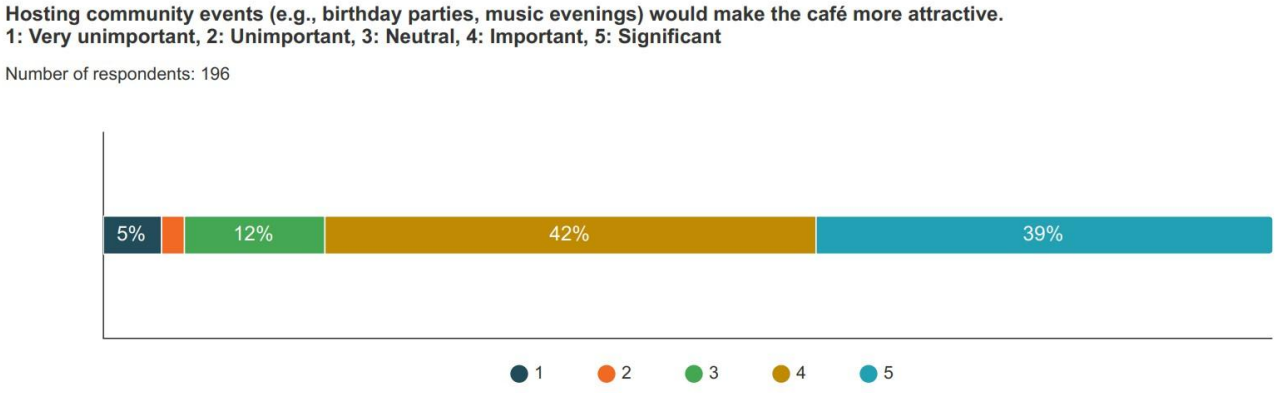
Figure 1. Do you live in Stige or nearby

3.2 Results of hosting community events, personal service, and opening hours of the cafe

Hosting community events (e.g., birthday parties, music evenings) would make the café more attractive

A large majority of respondents see community events as an attractive feature, with 42% rating it important and 39% rating it significant. The average score of 4.1 indicates strong overall agreement. With more than 80% in the top two categories, the results highlight that a café in Stige could

successfully serve as a cultural and social hub, consistent with the “third place” role of cafés described by Oldenburg (2002).

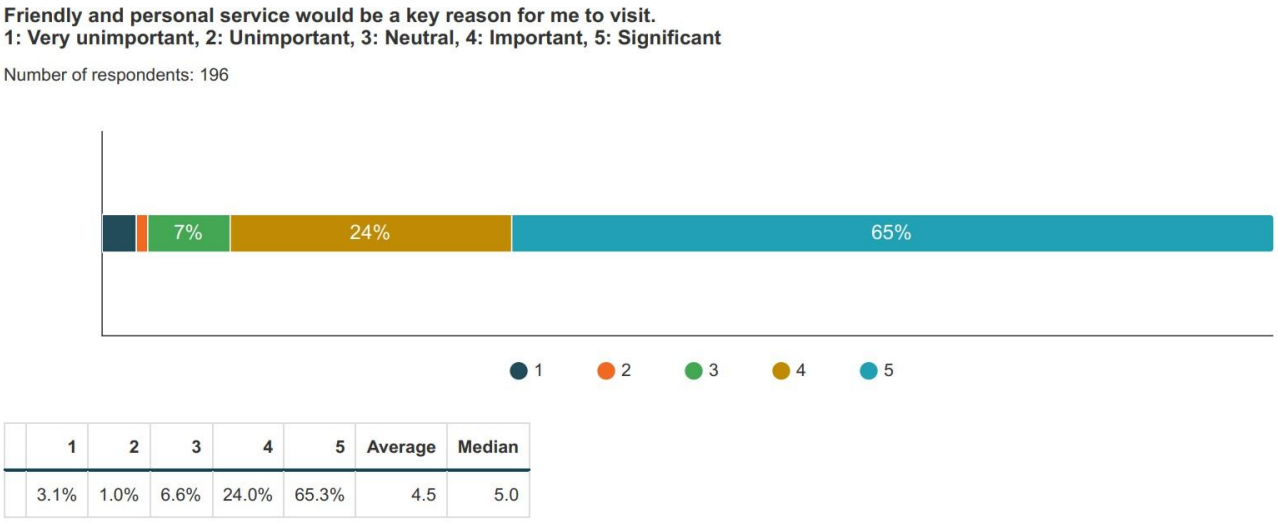


	1	2	3	4	5	Average	Median
	5.1%	2.6%	11.7%	41.8%	38.8%	4.1	4.0

Figure 2. Hosting community events (e.g., birthday parties, music evenings) would make the café more attractive

Friendly and personal service would be a key reason for me to visit

Friendly and personal service is clearly the most important factor for respondents when considering whether to visit a café in Stige. Nearly two-thirds (65.3%) rated it significant, while another 24% rated it important. Only around 5% considered it unimportant. With an average score of 4.5, the data indicate not only a high overall importance but also a strong consensus that most respondents were at the top end of the scale. This finding points out the central role of hospitality and human interaction in café culture. It reflects international research on “third places,” where personal connection and a sense of welcome are as important as the physical environment (Oldenburg, 2002). In the Danish context, it also collaborates with the concept of hygge, where warmth, familiarity, and friendliness are central to the café experience (Wiking, 2016).

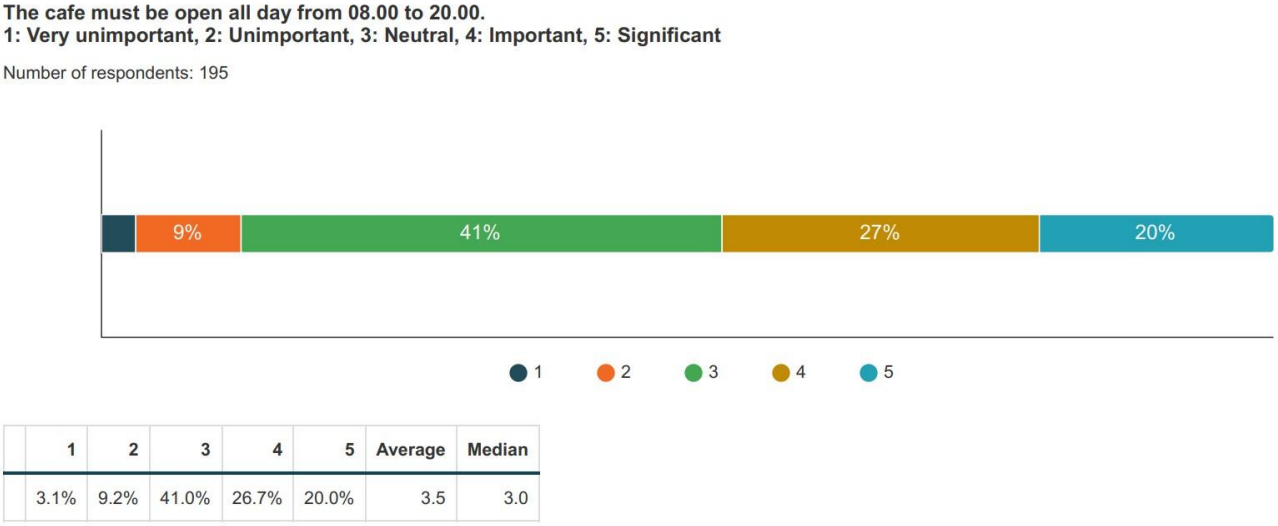


	1	2	3	4	5	Average	Median
	3.1%	1.0%	6.6%	24.0%	65.3%	4.5	5.0

Figure 3. Friendly and personal service would be a key reason for me to visit

The café must be open all day from 08.00 to 20.00

Respondents were more divided on the importance of long opening hours. While 26.7% rated it important and 20% significant, the largest share (41%) considered it only neutral. Around 12% indicated that long hours would be unimportant. With an average score of 3.5, this item shows relatively lower importance compared to other service-related factors, such as friendly service or community events. This suggests that while extended hours could be valued by some segments (e.g., commuters, students), they are not a decisive factor for most residents. From a business perspective, this suggests that flexible or partial-day opening strategies may still meet the needs of the majority of people. Literature on café operations in small communities supports the idea that customer experience and atmosphere often outweigh extensive opening times in driving visits (Clark, 2013; Oldenburg, 2002).



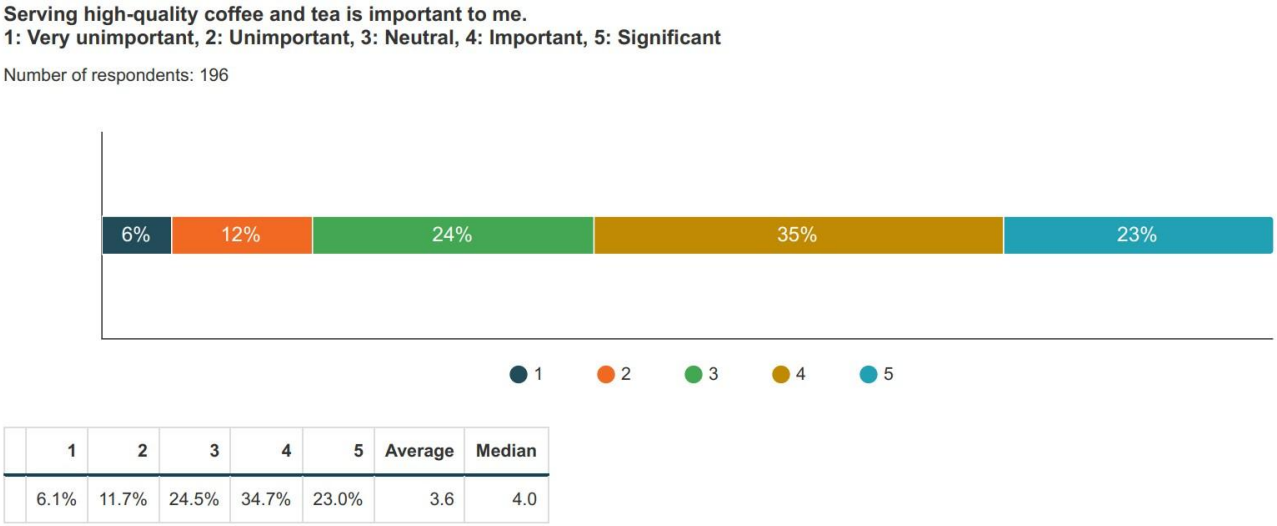
	1	2	3	4	5	Average	Median
	3.1%	9.2%	41.0%	26.7%	20.0%	3.5	3.0

Figure 4. The café must be open all day from 08.00 to 20.00

3.3 Results of the product quality, alcoholic beverages, and healthy food

Serving high-quality coffee and tea is important to me

Respondents showed moderate support for the importance of high-quality coffee and tea. A combined 57.7% rated it important or significant, with 34.7% selecting important and 23% significant. About one-quarter (24.5%) remained neutral, while 18% considered this factor unimportant. The average score of 3.6 suggests that while quality coffee is valued, it is not decisive. This indicates that in the Stige context, residents may not prioritize specialty-grade coffee to the same extent as urban consumers in cities like Copenhagen or Aarhus, where the third-wave coffee movement (e.g., Coffee Collective, La Cabra) is well established (Fresh Cup, 2023). Instead, the data suggests that good-quality but accessible coffee and tea, complemented by a welcoming atmosphere, may better match local expectations.

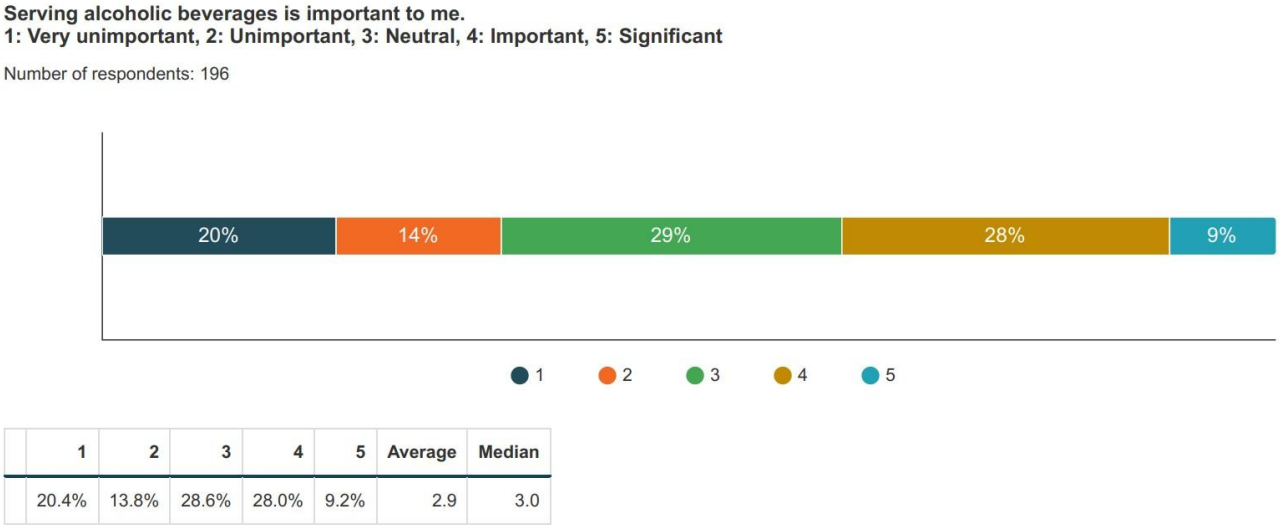


	1	2	3	4	5	Average	Median
	6.1%	11.7%	24.5%	34.7%	23.0%	3.6	4.0

Figure 5. Serving high-quality coffee and tea is important to me

Serving alcoholic beverages is important to me

The results show mixed opinions on the importance of alcoholic beverages in a café setting. While 28% rated it important and 9.2% significant, a larger share considered it neutral (28.6%) or unimportant (34.2%). The average score of 2.9 reflects this ambivalence, with opinions spread across the scale rather than weighted at one end. From a business perspective, this suggests that serving alcohol may be a secondary offering rather than a core expectation among residents. A café in Stige could consider offering limited or occasional alcoholic options (e.g., wine, craft beer for evening events) rather than developing a full café-bar model. This finding is consistent with broader Danish café culture, where alcohol is less central than coffee, tea, and light meals, and is often integrated selectively in cafés that host cultural or evening events (Kjeldgaard & Östberg, 2007).

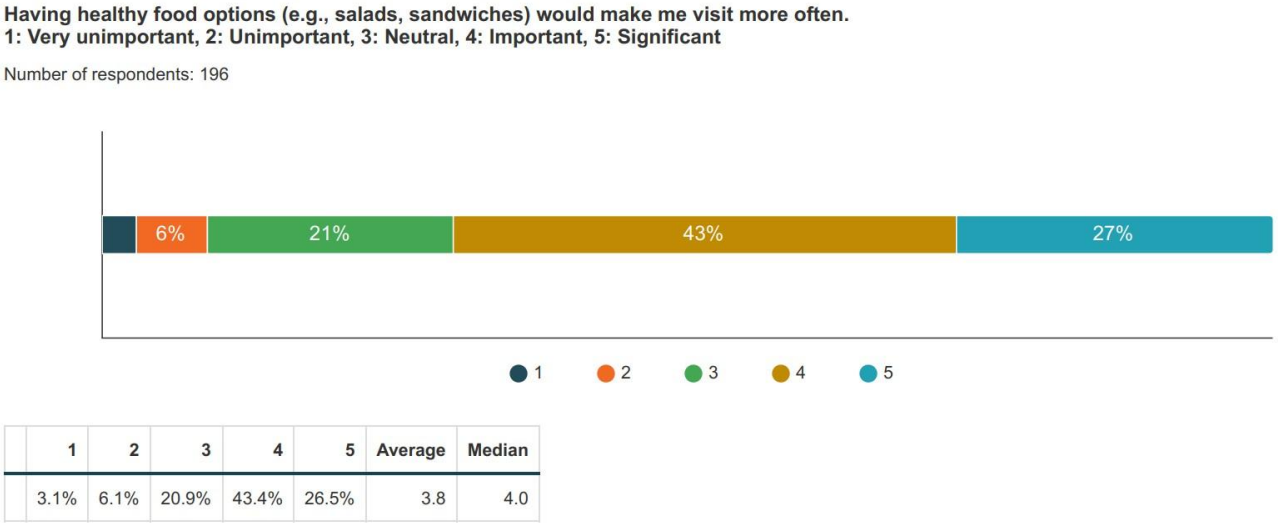


	1	2	3	4	5	Average	Median
	20.4%	13.8%	28.6%	28.0%	9.2%	2.9	3.0

Figure 6. Serving alcoholic beverages is important to me

Having healthy food options (e.g., salads, sandwiches) would make me visit more often

Healthy food options are seen as an important factor by a clear majority of respondents. Over two-thirds (69.9%) rated them as important or significant, with 43.4% choosing important and 26.5% significant. Only about 9% considered healthy options unimportant. The average score of 3.8 indicates a consensus toward valuing such offerings. This reflects broader consumer trends in Denmark and internationally, where demand for fresh, organic, and healthier menu items has grown steadily (Kjeldgaard & Östberg, 2007; Fresh Cup, 2023). For a café in Stige, incorporating nutritious options such as salads, sandwiches, or lighter meals would likely increase customer frequency and align with modern lifestyle preferences. This also supports the idea that cafés are no longer only about coffee but about a wider experience of wellbeing and balance, closely connected to concepts like hygge and social sustainability.

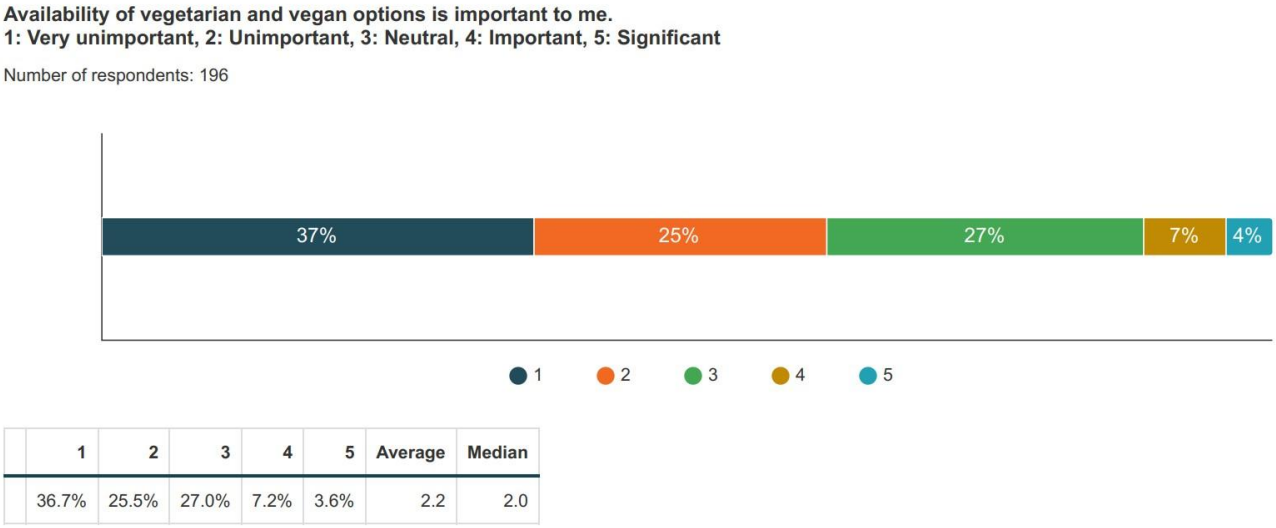


	1	2	3	4	5	Average	Median
	3.1%	6.1%	20.9%	43.4%	26.5%	3.8	4.0

Figure 7. Having healthy food options (e.g., salads, sandwiches) would make me visit more often

Availability of vegetarian and vegan options is important to me

Vegetarian and vegan options were rated as relatively unimportant by most respondents. Over 62% rated them very unimportant (36.7%) or unimportant (25.5%). Only a small minority (10.8%) considered them important and significant. The average score of 2.2 clearly shows that, for the local population, plant-based options are not a decisive factor in visiting a café. This result contrasts with broader urban café trends in Denmark, where vegetarian and vegan offerings are increasingly standard, especially in cities like Copenhagen and Aarhus (La Cabra, Coffee Collective). For Stige, however, the data suggests that a limited offering of plant-based choices may be sufficient, rather than making it a central focus of the menu. The main emphasis should remain on quality, traditional, and healthy everyday options that better match local demand.



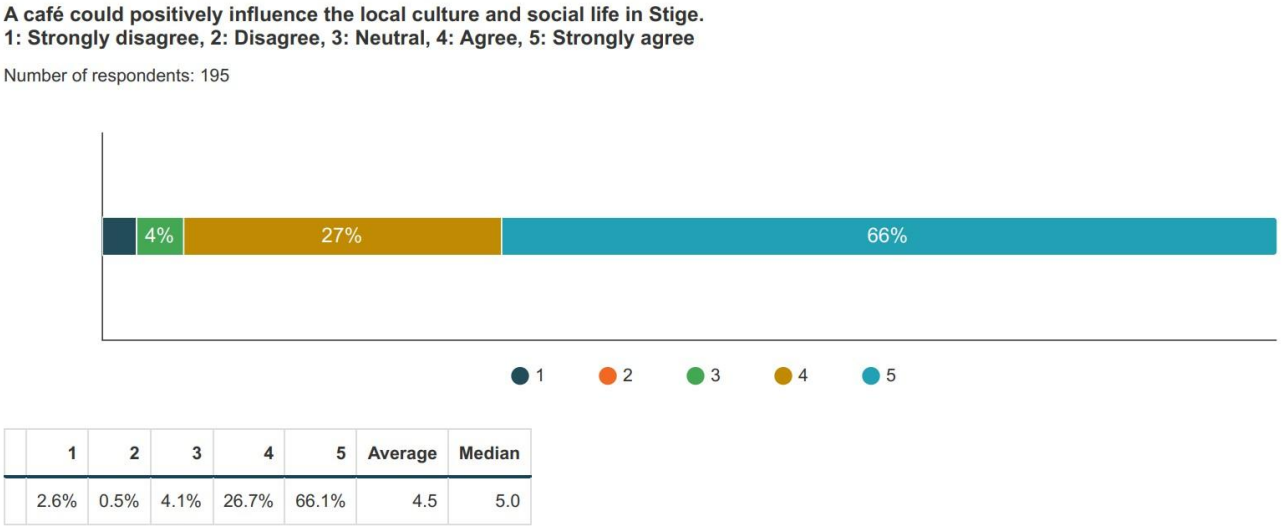
	1	2	3	4	5	Average	Median
	36.7%	25.5%	27.0%	7.2%	3.6%	2.2	2.0

Figure 8. Availability of vegetarian and vegan options is important to me

3.4 Results of local culture, and the café as a meeting place

A café could positively influence the local culture and social life in Stige

This statement received overwhelmingly positive responses. Two-thirds of respondents (66.1%) strongly agreed and a further 26.7% agreed that a café would positively impact local culture and social life. Only a tiny minority (around 3%) disagreed. The high average score of 4.5 shows a strong consensus that a café in Stige would be more than just a commercial success: it would become a community hub. This aligns closely with Ray Oldenburg's (2002) theory of cafés as "third places," which play a vital role in social interaction beyond home and work. It also reflects the Danish cultural concept of hygge, where cafés are often seen as spaces of warmth, belonging, and shared experience (Wiking, 2016). For Stige, the survey indicates that residents perceive a café not only as a provider of food and beverages but also as a social infrastructure investment with strong community-building potential.

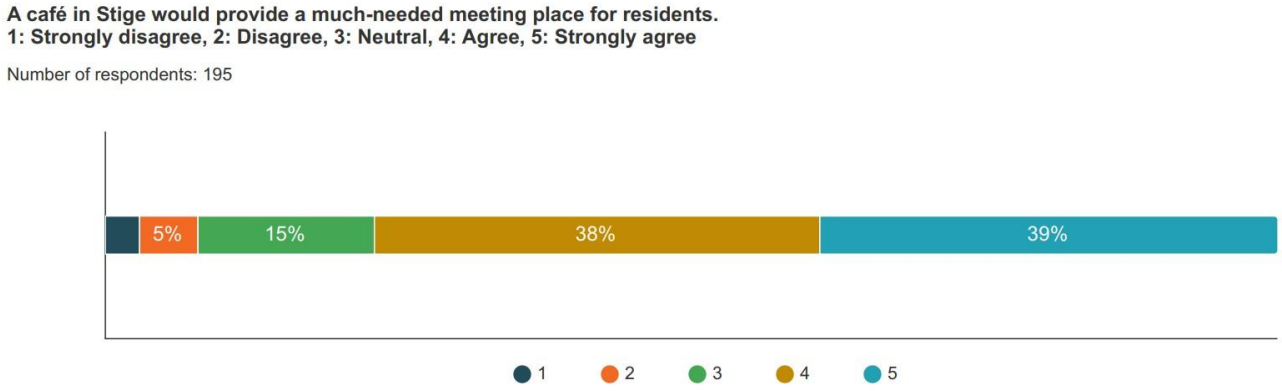


	1	2	3	4	5	Average	Median
	2.6%	0.5%	4.1%	26.7%	66.1%	4.5	5.0

Figure 9. A café could positively influence the local culture and social life in Stige

A café in Stige would provide a much-needed meeting place for residents

The majority of respondents agreed that a café would serve as an important meeting place for Stige residents. Nearly 40% strongly agreed and 38.4% agreed, while only about 7% disagreed. The average score of 4.1 shows a clear tendency toward agreement, though with slightly more variation compared to Q8 (cultural/social impact). These results strengthen the idea that residents see value in a café as a community space rather than just a commercial outlet. The responses align with Oldenburg's (2002) concept of the café as a "third place," where informal, accessible, and welcoming spaces strengthen social ties. In a small town like Stige, where few such venues exist, the café could help reduce social isolation and provide a neutral ground for everyday encounters, reflecting both hygge values and the Danish tradition of using cafés as hubs of belonging.



	1	2	3	4	5	Average	Median
	2.6%	4.6%	14.9%	38.4%	39.5%	4.1	4.0

Figure 10. A café in Stige would provide a much-needed meeting place for residents

3.5 Results of what would enhance the visit to the café

What services or products or cultural events would make you most likely to visit a café in Stige regularly?

A total of 116 open-ended responses were received and analyzed thematically. The answers were categorized into service-related, product-related, and cultural/community-related themes. The answers have been translated with a translator (Deep L 2025), from Danish to English.

Service-related answers

Many respondents preferred practical comfort and inclusiveness. Several mentioned the need for child-friendly facilities, such as *"a children's play area where parents can sit and still see their kids"* or *"highchairs for small children."* Others valued flexibility and accessibility, asking for *"clear opening hours, especially weekends and evenings,"* and affordable prices so that *"everyone, from pensioners to young people, can join."* Atmosphere was also central: people wanted *"a cozy interior, comfortable seating, and space to just be without pressure to buy every time."* Some suggested features like workspace areas for homework or laptop use, and meeting-room rental for small gatherings. A few proposed loyalty systems, such as a *"coffee card"* to reward regular customers. Overall, the responses highlight a need for a friendly, flexible, and welcoming service experience, aligning with Danish café traditions of hygge and community.

Product-related answers

Food and drink quality emerged as the main motivators for regular visits. Many respondents mentioned *“good cakes, bread, and homemade food”* as central attractions. Breakfast and brunch options were frequently requested, as were *“simple but good café dishes.”* Several people stressed dietary variety, asking for *“gluten- and lactose-free products”* and *“healthy options such as salads, sandwiches, and light dinners.”* While most respondents associated the café primarily with coffee and tea, some of them welcomed limited alcoholic offerings like *“wine or beer in the evening”* or *“a Friday bar, but not a drinking place.”* A few mentioned seasonal drinks such as *“mulled wine or special summer juices.”* In short, participants preferred familiar, homemade food and beverages, with moderate pricing and a touch of creativity, reflecting small-town expectations of simplicity combined with quality.

Cultural and community-related answers

The most frequently mentioned ideas related to social and cultural activities. Many respondents envisioned the café as a local meeting hub that would host events such as *“live music, jam sessions, and small concerts.”* Others proposed creative or educational gatherings, including *“knitting or crochet evenings,” “talks and lectures by local authors,”* and *“art exhibitions showing local artists’ work.”* Respondents also mentioned interactive social formats: *“board-game nights, quizzes, shared dining evenings, karaoke, or film screenings.”* Family and intergenerational events were valued — *“activities for children and grandparents together”* — as were community-building ideas, such as a *“book exchange corner”* or *“history wall with old photos of Stige.”* These findings show that residents view a café not just as a commercial business, but as a space for cultural participation and belonging, strongly indicating the “third place” concept (Oldenburg 2002) and the Danish ideal of *hygge* (Wiking 2016).

4 Discussion

This chapter discusses the main findings of the research in relation to the theoretical framework and previous studies. The results of the survey are analysed and reflected upon to evaluate whether opening a café in Stige would be realistic and beneficial for the local community. The discussion also includes my own observations and personal experiences from visiting cafés and exploring café culture in small towns in Denmark. These insights help to interpret the results and to assess the potential of a café concept in Stige from a practical point of view. In addition, the chapter considers the reliability and validity of the results and presents conclusions and suggestions for future development. Finally, I reflect on my learning and the overall thesis process.

4.1 Research process and evaluation

Objectives of the work

The main objective of this thesis was to explore the potential of opening a café in Stige and to understand how café culture functions in small Danish towns. The purpose was to identify what kind of products, services, and cultural elements local residents would value most in such a café concept. The research aimed to answer whether a café in Stige could be both economically viable and socially meaningful for the local community.

The topic was chosen because of my personal interest in café culture and my desire to open my own café in my residential town in Stige. I wanted to understand what makes certain cafés successful and welcoming, and whether the same principles could be applied in Stige. Through the survey and analysis, these objectives were achieved. The results provided clear insights into local expectations and needs, showing that people value cafés as social meeting points that create atmosphere, connection, and a sense of belonging. The combination of theoretical knowledge, previous studies, and empirical findings gave me a deeper understanding of how cafés contribute to community life and how this could be realized in practice in Stige.

Main results and key outcomes

The main results of the study show that residents in Stige are open to the idea of a local café that combines good-quality products with a cozy and social atmosphere. The survey showed that people value cafés not only for coffee and food but also as important meeting places that strengthen community life. Respondents highlighted the importance of homemade and locally sourced food, friendly service, and a welcoming environment suitable for both families and individuals. Many participants also expressed interest in cultural activities such as live music, knitting clubs, or small local events that would bring people together. These results confirm that there is potential for a café

in Stige if it focuses on creating a sense of community and offers experiences beyond traditional food service. The findings also support the theoretical framework, which describes cafés as “third places” that play a significant social and cultural role in small communities.

4.2 Conclusions and future outlook

Conclusion based on the results

The results of the study indicate that there is clear potential for establishing a café in Stige, as the local residents expressed a strong interest in having a social and welcoming place to gather. However, the café’s success would depend on how well it responds to the community’s expectations and values. It should not only provide good-quality coffee, food, and service but also create an inviting atmosphere where people can meet, relax, and connect.

The research findings show that people in Stige appreciate authenticity, local identity, and a sense of belonging more than standardized or chain-style café concepts. Therefore, a café that highlights healthy products, friendliness, and small-scale cultural activities could become a natural meeting point in the town. In connection to the theoretical framework, which emphasizes cafés as important “third places,” the results suggest that such a café could play a valuable role in supporting community life and enhancing the overall social well-being of the area.

Utilization and practical application of the results

The results of the research can be applied in practice when planning or developing a café concept in Stige or in other small towns with similar characteristics. The findings provide clear guidance on what local customers value most: a warm atmosphere, friendly service, and locally inspired products. Entrepreneurs or community members interested in starting a café can use these insights to design a concept that fits the expectations and preferences of local residents. The study also highlights the importance of integrating cultural and social activities into the café’s operations. Organising events such as small concerts, art exhibitions, or knitting clubs can increase customer loyalty and strengthen the café’s position as a social hub. From a broader perspective, the results could be used by local development associations or municipalities that wish to encourage social life and entrepreneurship in rural areas. In my own reflection, I see that the results offer a realistic foundation for considering a café project in Stige. If approached with authenticity, community focus, and local collaboration, the café could become both a sustainable business and a valuable addition to the social life of the town. Without investigating the facts, a downside factor can be the lack of potential locations in Stige. Another fact can be high rent prices, which can lead to contradict any sustainable business model.

Reliability and validity of the results

The thesis used both a survey and expert interviews to examine café culture and community engagement in Stige. Combining these two methods increased the overall credibility of the results. The online survey was open to everyone in the local community, which provided a broad overview of opinions. However, because the respondents was limited, the results cannot be considered statistically representative of the entire population. Still, the responses offer a reliable picture of local attitudes and expectations. The use of clear and simple questions, as well as anonymous participation, supported reliability. The survey and interview questions were directly based on the thesis objectives, which ensured that the data collected were relevant. Overall, the results can be considered trustworthy within the small-town context of Stige.

What was successful, and what were some challenges

Some aspects of the thesis process and research turned out to be successful. First, the data collection through the online survey worked well and reached a relatively large number of respondents for a small community like Stige. The responses were detailed and provided valuable information about people's preferences, needs, and ideas about a local café. Generally, the local public was happy about the idea of opening a café, and I even had an email confirming the help and necessary information in case the cafe opening was realized. This confirmed that the research topic was relevant and meaningful for the local population.

The thesis also faced some challenges during the process. One of the main difficulties was related to data collection. Although the number of survey responses was satisfactory, it was not fully representative of the whole population in Stige. This limited the possibility of making completely general conclusions about the entire community. Another challenge was the process of analysing and categorising open-ended survey answers. Many responses were detailed and diverse, which made it time-consuming to group them meaningfully. This was solved by developing clear categories: products, services, and cultural activities, which helped structure the analysis and make the results easier to interpret.

Ideas for future development

During the research process, several ideas for future development emerged. One of the most relevant ideas is to further explore the concept of a community-based café in Stige, possibly through a pilot project or collaboration with local associations. Such a café could operate partly as a social enterprise, combining business goals with community engagement.

Another idea is to develop a more detailed business plan or feasibility study based on the results of this thesis. This could include a financial analysis, location assessment, and marketing plan focusing on local and regional customers. Organising meetings with residents to co-create the café's concept could also strengthen local ownership and increase the chances of long-term success.

From a research perspective, future studies could examine café culture in other small towns in Denmark to identify similarities and differences. This would help understand how café concepts can adapt to different community needs while maintaining a shared focus on social connection, atmosphere, and local identity.

What have I learned?

Working on this thesis has been a valuable learning experience, both academically and personally. I have gained a deeper understanding of how cafés can function as important social spaces that bring people together, especially in smaller communities. Through the research process, I learned how to design and conduct a survey, analyse data, and connect practical findings with theoretical concepts. This strengthened my skills in research methodology and critical thinking.

I also learned to manage challenges such as time planning, data analysis, and academic writing more effectively. It added important aspects to my more than a decade-long working experience in the hospitality industry. Most importantly, it confirmed my interest in café culture and entrepreneurship, and inspired me to think more concretely about how such a concept could be realised in practice in a community like Stige.

References

Café Paraplyen URL: https://paraplyen-odense.dk/ Accessed 03.09.2025.

Café Sølle URL: https://cafesoelle.dk/ Accessed 02.09.2025.

Café StudieStuen URL: https://studenterguiden.dk/CafeStudieStuen/Odense/Cafeer/by-guidested/4751 Accessed 05.09.2025

Café Unika URL: https://cafeunika.dk/ Accessed 03.09.2025.

Tucker, C. M. 2011, Coffee culture: Local experiences, global connections, Routledge.

Coffee and Tea Industry Association (Brancheforeningen kaffe og te) 2024, *Coffee in numbers*, URL: https://bkt.dk/kaffens-tal/ Accessed 14.09.2025.

Coffee Collective URL: https://coffeecollective.dk/ Accessed 12. 09.2025.

Kjeldgaard, D.& Ostberg, J. 2007. Coffee Grounds and the Global Cup: Global Consumer Culture in Scandinavia. Consumption Markets & Culture, 10(2), 175-187.

Fyns AMTS Avis. 19.07.2023. Den danske kaffe kultur:Derfor er kaffe så populær (Danish coffee culture: Thays why coffee is so popular). URL: https://faa.dk/annoncoerbetaltindhold/den-danske-kaffekultur-derfor-er-kaffe-saa-populaer. Accessed: 04.04.2025.

Holy Bean Coffee Roasters URL: https://holybean.dk/ Accessed 12.09.2025.

Johnson, R. L. & Morgan, G. B. 2016. Survey Scales: A Guide to Development, Analysis, and Reporting. Guilford Press.

Korshøj, K. 2025. Expert interview, 21 September 2025. Interview conducted by Gabor Wagner. Stige, Denmark.

La Cabra URL: https://lacabra.com/ Accessed 13.09.2025.

Odense Kommune population statistics URL: https://www.odense.dk/politik/oekonomi-og-effektstyring/regnskaber/aarsberetning-2024/strategisk-status#:~:text=Flere%20borgere%20i%20Odense,i%20forhold%20til%20%C3%A5ret%20f%C3%B8r. Accessed 15.09.2025

Papas Papbar URL: https://www.papbar.dk/ Accessed 05.09.2025.

Oldenburg, R. 2002. Celebrating the Third Place: Inspiring Stories about the ‘Great Good Places’. New York: Marlowe & Company.

Oldenburg, R. 1999. Eight Characteristics of “Third Places” URL: https://www.researchgate.net/figure/Oldenburgs-1999-eight-characteristics-of-third-places_tbl1_227515447 Accessed 02.09.2025.

Studenterhus URL: https://www.studenterhus.dk/ Accessed 05.09.2025.

Tal Dansk Café URL: https://www.odenseim.dk/tal-dansk-cafe Accessed 06.09.2025.

Clark, T.N. 2013. Café Cultures: An Analytical Framework. Cambio, 3(6)

Visit Denmark 2025. What is hygge? URL: https://www.visitdenmark.com/denmark/things-do/danish-culture/what-hygge. Accessed: 31.08.2025.

Weather Spark: Winter Weather in Odense, Denmark. URL: https://weatherspark.com/s/68594/3/Average-Winter-Weather-in-Odense-Denmark Accessed: 31.08.2025.

Wiking, M. 2016. The Little Book of Hygge: The Danish Way to Live Well. Penguin Life.

World Happiness Report 2025. URL: https://data.worldhappiness.report/table Accessed 01.09.2025.

Yonobi Pinch Pot Café Odense URL: https://yonobi.com/da/collections/keramik-kursus-odense?srsltid=AfmBOoouFwtJprW3h6zDEpkfNaf4GdCFsRWKMeiA__nJJPxuWORupnGr Accessed 04.09.2025.

Appendices

Appendix 1. The survey questions

1. Hosting community events (e.g., birthday parties, music evenings) would make the café more attractive.

2. Friendly and personal service would be a key reason for me to visit.

3. The café must be open all day from 08:00 to 20:00.

4. Serving high-quality coffee and tea is important to me.

5. Serving alcoholic beverages is important to me.

6. Having healthy food options (e.g., salads, sandwiches) would make me visit more often.

7. Availability of vegetarian and vegan options is important to me.

8. A café could positively influence the local culture and social life in Stige.

9. A café in Stige would provide a much-needed meeting place for residents.

10. What services, products, or cultural events would make you most likely to visit a café in Stige regularly?

11. Do you live in Stige or nearby?